acquired either that independence of secular authority or that superiority to other ecclesiastics that was achieved by the pope.' (*The History of Western Philosophy*, Simon & Schuster, p. 390).

19. Averil Cameron writes that it was with the Ottoman conquest of south-eastern Europe that the region was closed off from the intellectual developments that had existed within Byzantine society and led to the 'permanent identification of Byzantium with absolutism on the one hand and Orthodox spirituality on the other. The negativity that surrounds the idea of Byzantium is especially evident in the modern discourse of "balkanism", and the idea of "byzantinism", or "byzantinismus" plays an important part among the negative characteristics that mark out the Balkans from "Europe" and "the West".' See Cameron, pp.175–76. For more on the image of the Balkans see Maria Todorova's seminal work, *Imagining the Balkans.*

20. All data is from Maddison.